

Flour Frontier Executive Summary

Jake Gilstein · General Mills · NAF Sales · FSI West Zone · Flour Frontier

Project Overview

My project covers exploring what markets are best for accelerating flour growth despite excess industry capacity posing challenges and an overall declining consumption market. I built the analysis with Tableau, Nielsen DMA data, Circana data, Census projections, distributor invoice records, and conversations with both the FSI management team and the Account Executives who own the territories.

Strategic Readout

The work points to five metro priorities, the True 5: Houston, Dallas-Fort Worth, Atlanta, Tampa and Phoenix. These are not simply the five biggest metros or the highest raw scores. A large market is not automatically a priority market; New York City, for example, is huge, but GMI already holds 57.5% flour share there, so extra focus would not create the same headroom as a market where we are less developed by comparison. The ranking instead compares market scale, growth, our current position, distributor movement, cost-to-serve, and field validation. Houston and Dallas matter because the opportunity is large and immediate. Atlanta, Tampa, and Phoenix matter because they combine regional growth with clear reasons for sharper focus.

Priority Metro Logic

Rank	Metro	Score	Share	YoY	Posture
1	Houston	4.35	20.4%	+1.5%	Prioritize aggressively
2	Dallas-Ft. Worth	3.95	14.5%	+5.3%	Recover and refocus
3	Atlanta	3.50	23.8%	-1.5%	Expand coverage
4	Tampa-St. Pete	3.30	28.9%	+13.9%	Build steadily
5	Phoenix	2.80	~35.6%*	-0.7%	Strengthen position

One-Point Share Gain, By Metro

Metro	CWT/pt	RNS/pt
Houston	6,032	\$168,883
Dallas	4,977	\$139,349
Atlanta	3,677	\$102,970
Tampa	3,450	\$96,606
Phoenix*	~1,994	~\$55,843
True 5 total	~20,130	~\$563,650

*Back-calculated; Optika covers <50% of market, so figures are a directional floor.

**Value varies by metro since total category size differs.

Based on each metro's DMA-level total flour volume (Circana Optika) ÷ 100, priced at \$28/CWT:

Leadership Takeaway

Flour Frontier is a practical allocation and execution plan for getting more out of the current system. The immediate value is knowing where to lean in, where to protect position, and where the field believes the data needs pressure testing. The best next step is to use the top five metros as a focused FY27 test bed for distributor engagement, account targeting, cleaner label selling, and cost to serve improvement.

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